Parham Motaharimajd

Game Designer | Gameplay Systems Designer | Level Designer

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Portfolio: https://parhammotaharimajd.github.io/portfolio/

Summary

Game Designer with 1.5+ years of hands-on experience in gameplay systems, combat, multiplayer and level design using Unreal Engine 5 and Blueprints. Lead designer on an indie multiplayer game with a playable demo and an upcoming Steam release. Skilled in playtesting, game balancing, rapid prototyping, iteration and game design documentation (GDD).

Experience

Weigh Out: First-Person Multiplayer Platformer

July 2026 – Present | Team of 3 | Unreal Engine 5 | Playable demo, Steam release planned for 2027

Role: Lead Game Designer; also character, animation, VFX, SFX, UI and Blueprints

- Built a multiplayer prototype in 6 days at a game jam in Iran; strong reactions from fellow jammers led the team to expand it into a full game.
- Designed a weight-based race: shots deal no damage and instead lighten the shooter and weigh down the target, changing jump height, fall speed and launch resistance. Added a one-use homing projectile as a comeback tool.
- Ran two playtest rounds. Found the core loop repetitive, then redesigned the level into escalating floors with rising lava and a 15-second final-platform hold, and added charger stations.
- Fixed usability problems found in testing: an opening camera sweep, a launcher HUD icon, a launcher-only breakable cell wall that teaches the core mechanic, and a numeric weight scale HUD.
- Led design for a team of 3 (design, Blueprint programming, environment art), documented the game in a full GDD, and made the character, VFX, SFX and UI.

UGC: Multiplayer Third-Person Action Platformer

November 2025 – Present | Team of 3 | Unreal Engine 5 | In development, on hold for Weigh Out

Role: Game Designer / Developer

- Designed a team-vs-team boss race on a circular map with a central boss room and 8 ability and combat rooms linked by speed-boost pipes. Players choose between rushing the boss, collecting abilities or disrupting the other team.
- Designed abilities earned through platforming challenges of rising difficulty, including a choice between two gravity abilities (swinging or wall-walking) and a hand-drawn shield.
- Built a hybrid physics system (simulated spine and upper body, kinematic feet and hips) and fixed Steam multiplayer connection failures (App ID 480).

A Cigarette: 2.5D Action Platformer

March 2025 – August 2025 | Team of 4 | Unreal Engine 5 | Canceled after 5 months of prototyping

Role: Game Designer / Narrative and Mechanics

- Designed a burn mechanic where a cigarette protagonist shrinks as it lights torches, plus a timed combo system that restores size and breaks shielded enemies.
- Designed a face-free narrative system with an unseen narrator, removing facial animation and dialogue work.
- Led the decision to cancel after team and outside playtests showed the loop didn't work and the scope was too large; applied those lessons to Weigh Out.

Skills

Design: Gameplay Systems Design, Combat Design, Multiplayer Design, Level Design, Game Balancing, Game Design Documentation (GDD), Rapid Prototyping, Playtesting, Iteration, Narrative Design, UX/UI Design

Technical: Unreal Engine 5, Blueprints Visual Scripting, Niagara VFX, C++ (intermediate), Python (intermediate), Perforce (Helix Core), Steam

Art and Audio: Blender, ZBrush, Substance Painter, Marvelous Designer, 3D Modeling, 3D Animation, VFX, SFX, Logic Pro X

Education, Certifications and Languages

- Epic Games Game Design Professional Certificate (Coursera)
- Bachelor of Industrial Management, Mazandaran University, Babolsar
- Farsi (native) | English (C1, IELTS 7)